

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 24

MINNESOTA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Minnesota's family courts and child-welfare system.

88

MINNESOTA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 164 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 14 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 12, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
35 OF 87

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · MINNESOTA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Minnesota. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Darik Anderson

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · WINONA · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Not conducting an independent study, filling false documentation into court, Lying on the stand."* WINONA COUNTY MN

> *"Never evaluated the child's current living situation and lied on the stand."*

> *"Refused documents"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mn-darik-anderson/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Rebecca Church

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · WINONA · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"Lied and blocked court documents Crooked Assistans attorney who is completely out of line and lies"*

> *"lying to the judge, denning family placement, ignoring evidence"* WINONA COUNTY MN

> *"Refused paperwork"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/mn-rebecca-church/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

MINNESOTA AT A GLANCE.

Across 88 Minnesota families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
164
88 of 88 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$111,300
median across 37 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
14
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
56.8%
50 of 88 who answered; 35 of 88 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
88	1.9	88 of 88	35

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Minnesota families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF MINNESOTA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	46	$14,500	$46,270	$2,128,400
Lost Wages	45	$12,000	$69,466	$3,125,980
Other Court Fees	32	$1,004	$14,997	$479,904
Therapy / Evaluations	33	$500	$2,512	$82,900
Reunification Services	30	$150	$6,237	$187,100
GAL Fees	35	$500	$1,945	$68,059
Asset Loss [1]	45	$20,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (37 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$111,300	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($20,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · MINNESOTA

Most families documenting in Minnesota are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	35	40%
Case closed: within last 2 years	17	19%
Not provided	17	19%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	11	12%
Active case: progress being made	5	6%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	34	39%
Family Court Only	31	35%
CPS Only	19	22%
Unknown	4	5%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	23	26%
3 – 5 years	20	23%
6 months – 1 year	15	17%
5 – 10 years	10	11%
Over 10 years	10	11%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	22	25%
Visitation Only	18	20%
Full Custody	15	17%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)	12	14%
50/50 Joint	12	14%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Hennepin	8	12%
Ramsey	5	7%
Scott	4	6%
Crow Wing	4	6%
Koochiching	4	6%
Winona	4	6%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	21	24%
Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	21	24%
High Conflict Divorce	11	12%
Other	10	11%
Other: (Short answer)	9	10%

05 PARENT VOICES — MINNESOTA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Minnesota comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *Covered up abuse and silenced my kids and myself. Has not protected my son he lives with the step sister that molested him full time now!*
>
> — MELISSA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

It all started when the county did abatement on my property an discriminate an used slang words against my kids an me for no reason at all an for things that where not even true in the front page of the newspaper then are house burnt down they came an took are kids for no reason [...]

— MINNESOTA PARENT · NICOLE

MORE VOICES FROM MINNESOTA

I am beyond traumatized at the way the courts and cps handled my kids and took them from me. The cop Ben coop of Lewiston Minnesota police department arrested me on my own mother's property and manhandled me in a dress infront of my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed my son's childhood given him parental separation trauma, low self esteem, given me PTSD, awakened me to the corruption of the system of arbitrary power, control and greed. The system steals from us to feed itself and grow, just like cancer.

— DUSTIN

This fraudulent system is a cash for kids profiteering system. Sick!

— TYLER

They have shown how crooked and flawed the system is at preserving and protecting parent's constitutional rights to their children.

— HELENA-MARIE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Mn child protection has ruthlessly and maliciously damaged our family emotionally, spiritually, and financially. After being foster providers in a small town we became the target. Ever since the birth of my final and third child 8 years ago, we have been routinely surveillanced [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed my children trust in there's someone to help. Caused unimaginable stress that affects day today normal things..

— ANGELA

My ex followed through on his threats to take my children away from me. Family court, as an extension of his abuse, has stripped me of the one thing that actually mattered to me: motherhood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As a party to my grandson's case, and other stories in this county I was able to see the TRUTH of what CPS really is. Through the documents of CPS there are clear patterns on what these people do to family's most importantly to our children. The harm that was caused to my family [...]

— MICHELLE

It's broken me and I can only imagine the pain my children are in

— CAITLIN

Destroyed my family, killed one of my children, has separated all four of my children in two different housing placements

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They attempted to silence and assassinate me, my children, my faith and used my belief in God to persecute me and eventually traffick my daughter Lillian.

— KATHRYN

My kids were taken because my oldest wanted to make false clams against me because he wanted to live with his dad. And he got caught with porn on his phone and having not so nice messages with other children and my son got my other so to say things that where not true because he [...]

— AMANDA

Placed my children into a transvestite sex ring . Of physical abuse ignored by a friend group very powerful in my town

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Ripped child from home and 2 siblings, extended family and child has no rights. Loss of finance's, freedom and business income, added stree and trauma to all.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

They broke my family apart and never had no intentions of reniting us back together. I had 2 sets of twins and they stole my children.

— MOLLIE

This has traumatized and stolen our life from us. So many missed opportunities to be a normal person like everyone else, all because of a system that cycles families through a system that doesn't even work and leaves you financially broken and too stressed out to think straight.

— BUFFY

My ex, the court, and the attorneys bankrupted me, gave my abusive ex access to me, and continues to harm my family to this day.

— JESSICA

Legal abuse was rapant, real threats recorded, incorrect information reported, lack of due process, and obvious bias allowed. A safe, healthy, proactive and loving parent should not be forced into paying exuberant amounts of money to retain custody of their child. How unethical [...]

— ASHLEY

Ripped us apart as a family and perpetuated abuse that was already failed to be addressed. I've said the damage is already done and it's true; but will not be in vain.

— STEPHANIE

I have 7 more children in SD since my case in mn which proves my case is the strongest and easiest case to win if I had a lawyer. Same county that stole my son had prior paid me as unlicensed daycare provider for my sister's kids. I have enough to file federal lawsuit and 3 [...]

— ROBIN

Severely damaged my three children and their mental health, damaged my children's relationship and bond with me, and my family, financially destroyed me, causing significant debt.

— DONNA

They distroy my life and son life and little girl life.

— WES

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They have robbed me and my family of a normal family and they are still doing it to this day*
>
> — DUSTIN

This poor excuse of a family justice system costed me my life, literally. My daughter and son are my life and the very reason I breathe, but because of a bias referee and myself not being very knowledgeable when it came to representing myself in family court, I was literally [...]

— TAMARA

Destroyed lives of people & property financial exploitation REVICTINIZATION Not to the BEST INTEREST THEY LIE

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children were removed and court decisions were made before I was ever properly served or given notice, and I have been trying to participate in a process that moved forward without me. I initially intended to represent myself but was forced to request a court-appointed [...]

— ALICIA

Harassed, tormented and Traumatized and it's still continuing for over 5 years after I beat them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Minnesota court system has failed way me and keep me from my children. After they where moved out of state for 2 years

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lost my oldest son last 3 years of his life now that he is 19 he was taken away from me when he was 16 3 most important precious years of his life without due process no court hearings no nothing all because of carlton county here in cloquet minnesota one cps worker that made it [...]

— TISHINA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They gave my firstborn daughter to her molester because his mom had more money.*
>
> — MEGAN

Steve Shermone private attorney / city attorney /retired and Judge Jerrod Shermone's brother relationship created a conflict of interest in your case, and that an improperly handled ex parte motion contributed to a broader pattern of judicial bias and procedural violations. The [...]

— AMBER

It is literally destroyed me. It is me and my kids super sad some moaning talk to me now because they think I wasn't there when I was the guy I tried make it seem like I didn't love my kids or something, but all I wanted was my kids they've turned me into a person that. Didn't [...]

— BRADLEY

I lost my job because of them I feel lost without them family is very upset

— BRITTANY

Time, memories, activities-lost. Ability to seek employment-lost.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined my family. All relatiinships, finances, and careers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has hurt put my daughter in a very dangerous situation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I'm a mother with a love that has no where to go. I'm living in a paralyzed state and to live a life knowing your child is confused wondering where you are is the most painful thing,

— TABATHA

My whole body shakes and now I have GAD which causes issues like going to the post office, answering phone, checking emails, fear of a knock at the door and these agents Violated our Liberty and to top it off non of them have a lawful oath of office.

— DANIELLE

53 Minnesota parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — MINNESOTA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Minnesota families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> Covered up abuse and silenced my kids and myself. Has not protected my son he lives with the step sister that molested him full time now!
>
> — MELISSA

> It all started when the county did abatement on my property an discriminate an used slang words against my kids an me for no reason at all an for things that where not even true in the front page of the newspaper then are house burnt down they came an took are kids for no reason at all then when we bought a new house the health department went out to my property that I still own an they took all my brand new stuff from my property witch they had no reason to even be on my property or take my stuff an collapse my septic tank I should have been able to leave my stuff there being I own the property then a couple months after after i bought a new house the law enforcement came to my door with a sherch warrant an took all my guns an stuff from me for no reason at all me an my other half have nothing on are back rounds for them to do that an they still won't give us them back we are not criminals an just recently they made both of us apply for are permittes to purchase guns an they denied both of us an said that they took are gun rights away because of supposedly a pending felony but we have no open cases on either one of use an we are also still fighting to get 2 of my kids back from CPS taking them for no leight reason but yet I still have full custody of my oldest child 5 months after we had lost are whole life to a traffic house fire then the county went after me an my other half for fraud an my oldest child saying he didn't live with me when all 5 of us had not a place to live we where all homeless after the fire so where staying at hotels for 3 months strait an my oldest didn't like staying at the hotels so he would go stay at my parents house off an on with should have
>
> — NICOLE (1/3)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

never been a problem at all they are family an at the time being we where all homeless till we could get the insurance claim for are house figured out so we could all move forward with are family life together as we did before the fire so they sent the fraud case to a different county an in the end I won that whole case but have never seen anything back of the things the took from me an my family expecalkt when time was hard anyhow with lossing everything already an still to this day they just keep going at us for no reason at all we do nothing wrong an we hardly ever leave are house but yet the cops are sitting everywhere around are house all the time or following use around the harassment from the cops are getting old when all me an my family want in life is to be a family together an just start are new journey together after losing everything to a house fire but we just can't witch has really messed with me an my whole family's mental health for absolutely no reason at all an I have been trying to get me an my family's life tragedy story out there so my I could get someone to help us get back together as a family I have even tried reach out to lawyer to get help with all the eleagle things that have now been done to my family but can't find anyone to even give us any time in the day for nothing and I even have all the proof on all the things that have never been done to us for no reason at all but can't get no one to hear are sides of any of the things they have done to my family physical an emotional they have tookin everything away from my family an we now have NOTHING an can't even be that family that we had an we deserve cause we are human an no different from

— NICOLE (2/3)

anyone else here in this world we live we don't deserve the torcher the harassment the mental health problems so please if anyone has any good advice for us or could help us in any way would be very grateful appreciated. An help to us so we could move forward in life as the family we where before we lost everything to a house fire let us know please an thank you an God bless you.

— NICOLE (3/3)

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They have shown how crooked and flawed the system is at preserving and protecting parent's constitutional rights to their children.

— HELENA-MARIE

Mn child protection has ruthlessly and maliciously damaged our family emotionally, spiritually, and financially. After being foster providers in a small town we became the target. Ever since the birth of my final and third child 8 years ago, we have been routinely surveillanced, manipulated, and preyed upon for statistical and financial gain in a smaller northern MN county. The judge, attorney, assessors, visit facilitators, gals, workers, law enforcement from bottom to top all seem to be in a secret group where the only rules and laws that apply are theirs. My children have been hurt and abused in the system, swept under the rug with an internal "investigation " in 2019. They have repeatedly lied, saying we didn't have prescriptions that we did...and they ran out the permanentcy clock by not starting a trial home visit when my children were with me. My children were out of my care for 35 days...they put them ages 1 and 4 and 180 days right off the bat.

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

As a party to my grandson's case, and other stories in this county I was able to see the TRUTH of what CPS really is. Through the documents of CPS there are clear patterns on what these people do to family's most importantly to our children. The harm that was caused to my family is indescribable. I have not seen my grandson in a year and a half, there is clear evidence that he would never return to his family. He was SOLD, The county's make more money if children are adopted out to non-family members. I pray daily that I will see this child again soon, until then, I vow to get the documents that I have into the right hands. I pray for justice for all family's experiencing CPS / Corrupt profiting system.

— MICHELLE

It's broken me and I can only imagine the pain my children are in

— CAITLIN

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— BUFFY

My ex, the court, and the attorneys bankrupted me, gave my abusive ex access to me, and continues to harm my family to this day.

— JESSICA

Legal abuse was rapant, real threats recorded, incorrect information reported, lack of due process, and obvious bias allowed. A safe, healthy, proactive and loving parent should not be forced into paying exuberant amounts of money to retain custody of their child. How unethical to know that custody court pays wins to the person with the most money and willingness to break the most rules, while those that follow the rules are ignored. When violence is allowed and threats given power, peace and justice cannot occur. A child's best interest is not the focus at any point, but instead the winner is the one with the most financial power and ability to destroy the other party. It is not about who is the best parent, it is about who is the most destructive. My innate right to raise my child is captive by someone with more financial means than me. This is not justice, this is corruption, this is harm and alienation, this is future expenses and health disparities, this is giving power to the people this government is sworn to defend against. This is taking the purest part of life and weaponizing it to unnecessary and harmful extremes. Good parents are being victimized by bad parents and those are the victors of the court system- who is paid off by disparities and continued orders and financial burdens. Problems must exist for the courts and actors to capitalize it, solutions are not the goal.

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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— ROBIN

Severely damaged my three children and their mental health, damaged my children's relationship and bond with me, and my family, financially destroyed me, causing significant debt.

— DONNA

They distroy my life and son life and little girl life.

— WES

They have robbed me and my family of a normal family and they are still doing it to this day

— DUSTIN

This poor excuse of a family justice system costed me my life, literally. My daughter and son are my life and the very reason I breathe, but because of a bias referee and myself not being very knowledgeable when it came to representing myself in family court, I was literally prayed upon. I thought the truth would set me free and I jumped through every hoop I was asked to and not asked to do and I proved everything my exhusband was alleging against me as false and still I lost my kids not all at once, it started little by little and eventually nothing.

— TAMARA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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Lost my oldest son last 3 years of his life now that he is 19 he was taken away from me when he was 16 3 most important precious years of his life without due process no court hearings no nothing all because of carlton county here in cloquet minnesota one cps worker that made it happen name Raija Haag and her superviser Samantha hill made it happen I lost my oldest daughter this year she was 15 years old by another cps worker name jana hoglum here in cloquet minnesota also by Carlton county it definitely has made an impact on me and my family it has been a hard journey lots of years and heartbreak our family hasn't been the same since 2022 there were several cases that the county had filed against me we finally had all my children together for Thanksgiving this year and Christmas cause my family helped with that including my mom but our family were grieving for the last couple of years due to the cases that were open it has definitely impacted my relationships with them and it's hard for my older ones to reach out to me I have lots to explain to you wish I had more time to talk to you about everything that has happened to my family and my children due to cps here in cloquet minnesota (Carlton county)

— TISHINA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They gave my firstborn daughter to her molester because his mom had more money.

— MEGAN

Steve Shermone private attorney / city attorney /retired and Judge Jerrod Shermone's brother relationship created a conflict of interest in your case, and that an improperly handled ex parte motion contributed to a broader pattern of judicial bias and procedural violations. The family relationship was not disclosed or properly screened for conflict under judicial ethics standards. - Decisions affecting your case were made in a context where impartiality could reasonably be questioned due to the familial connection. - You believe an ex parte motion was filed or processed improperly, without your knowledge or opportunity to respond, and that this action materially harmed your case. - These events contributed to a pattern of procedural irregularities, lack of transparency, and decisions that appeared to favor individuals connected to the Shermone family network.

— AMBER

It is literally destroyed me. It is me and my kids super sad some moaning talk to me now because they think I wasn't there when I was the guy I tried make it seem like I didn't love my kids or something, but all I wanted was my kids they've turned me into a person that. Didn't care about nothing after they cut my kids and I want my life back. I deserve my kids back.

— BRADLEY

I lost my job because of them I feel lost without them family is very upset

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Time, memories, activities-lost. Ability to seek employment-lost.

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— TABATHA

My whole body shakes and now I have GAD which causes issues like going to the post office, answering phone, checking emails, fear of a knock at the door and these agents Violated our Liberty and to top it off non of them have a lawful oath of office.

— DANIELLE

The family court system has handed my children to a documented abuser and Cluster B individual putting our children in harms way. This monster has a porn addiction intertwined with drugs and violence. My children are not safe with him- their emotional health, physical health, and education has all been affected. He continues to withhold my children despite the 3 court orders allowing me video calls with my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Disparaged and put in danger

— ALICIA

Taken valuable time and moments that we will never get back and the y drove a wedge between us. They do everything they could do divide and separate us when they were supposed to be reunifying our family

— TESSA

Made us hate each other more than we did before the divorce

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Caused major physical harm to my daughter, and made sure we couldn't live on our own for years. Sucked us financially dry...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court system has profited from not only ripping my family apart; the one I gave up my career to build, but protecting the one who threw everything I build in the garbage, and continued to profit over allowing him to perpetuate neurological battery that has developed severe nervous system dysregulation. The epitome of corruption.

— SARA J

I can't change the cards I was dealt. I can only change the way I play the game. God always provides my team. A pawn can take out the King. The system tried to break us while God built us..

— JOCELYN

They ruined our lives

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

BROUGHT US TO THE TRUTH AMD THAT IS God SEES EVERYTHING amd what they have done to us is nothing compared to what they are going to experience when God is before them.on judgme t day so I pray that they STOP amd repent and don't hide because you are about to have a very bright light on you. It will hurt more than your eyes..You can't ever destroy the body between mother and her child, what you stole from us is just a glimpse of what will be stolen from you. REPENT and turn back to God that's who you are under oath with when you were sworn in.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ive been a Respondent in the family court system and petitioner of a 2nd HRO which was denied. I've gone thru the proper channels. Being the transparent parent in the court system isnt

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Systemic Parental Alientation
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> It has broken a special bond between a grandmother and grandchild. It has caused mental harm to the child and our family suffers every day missing him.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I made sure to have professionals backing up my claims thinking it would be a quick case. Because he has money he has been able to draw it out which is not in the best interest of the child. Courts don't care. It's just about the money.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

53 full approved Minnesota comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Minnesota report comes from Minnesota respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Minnesota — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 88 Minnesota families reporting here are not the universe of Minnesota families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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